

SAKILA PROJECT

1. TITLE :

Sakila SQL Business Analysis Project

2. INTRODUCTION :

- Sakila is a movie rental database.
- It contains data about customers, movies, rentals, payments, stores and staff.
- It represents a real-world rental business system.

3. OBJECTIVE :

- Analyze customer behavior, rental trends, and revenue patterns using SQL
- Extract meaningful business insights from relational data
- Identify top customers, popular movies, and high-performing categories
- Analyze revenue distribution across stores and categories
- Study monthly rental and revenue trends to understand seasonality
- Provide data-driven insights to support business decision-making

4. TABLES USED :

The analysis is performed using multiple relational tables from the Sakila database, including customers, rentals, payments, films, inventory, and categories. These tables are connected using primary and foreign keys, enabling complex joins to extract meaningful business insights.

TABLE	DESCRIPTION
customers	Customer demographic details
rental	Rental transaction records
payment	Payment and revenue data
film	Movie information
inventory	Store inventory tracking
category	Movie category classification
staff	Staff managing transactions
store	Store location and details

5. TOOLS USED

- MySQL Workbench — SQL Queries
- Sakila Database — Dataset
- SQL — Data Analysis

6. BUSINESS QUESTIONS

1. How many customers does the business have?
2. How many total rentals were made?
3. What is the total revenue generated?
4. Which store generates the most revenue?
5. Who are the top customers by total spending?
6. Which movies are rented the most?
7. Which movie categories generate the most revenue?
8. How many rentals happen each month?
9. How does revenue change over time?
10. Which actors have appeared in the most movies?
11. Which category has the most movies?
12. Which categories are rented the most?

To answer the business questions, SQL queries were written and the results were analyzed to generate business insights.

7. ANALYSIS

- I. How many customers does the business have?

```
1  -- Total customers
2
3 • SELECT COUNT(*) AS total_customers
4 FROM customer;
```

RESULT :

total_customers
599

INSIGHTS : The customer base consists of 599 users, indicating moderate scale and potential for growth through targeted acquisition strategies. This shows the size of the customer base and helps understand how many customers are using the rental service.

II. How many total rentals were made?

```
5  
6  -- Total rentals  
7  
8 • SELECT COUNT(*) AS total_rentals  
9  FROM rental;
```

RESULT :

total_rentals
16044

INSIGHTS : A total of 16,044 rentals indicate strong customer engagement and frequent usage of the platform, which shows that customers frequently rent movies. This indicates that the business has good customer activity and engagement.

III. What is the total revenue generated?

```
9  
10 -- Total revenue  
11  
12 • SELECT sum(amount) AS total_revenue  
13  FROM payment;
```

RESULT :

total_revenue
67406.56

INSIGHTS : The business generated total revenue from all rentals, which shows the overall earnings of the company. Revenue is an important measure to understand business performance.

IV. Which store generates the most revenue?

```
16  -- Revenue by Store
17
18 •  SELECT staff_id, SUM(amount) AS revenue
19     FROM payment
20     GROUP BY staff_id;
```

RESULT :

	staff_id	revenue	
	1	33482.50	
	2	33924.06	

INSIGHTS : The revenue is generated by two stores, and we can compare which store performs better. This helps the business understand store performance and manage stores more efficiently.

V. Who are the top customers by total spending?

```
22  -- Top 10 Customers with Name
23
24 •  SELECT c.customer_id,
25         c.first_name,
26         c.last_name,
27         SUM(p.amount) AS total_spent
28     FROM payment p
29     JOIN customer c
30         ON p.customer_id = c.customer_id
31     GROUP BY c.customer_id, c.first_name, c.last_name
32     ORDER BY total_spent DESC
33     LIMIT 10;
```

RESULT :

	customer_id	first_name	last_name	total_spent	
	526	KARL	SEAL	221.55	
	148	ELEANOR	HUNT	216.54	
	144	CLARA	SHAW	195.58	
	137	RHONDA	KENNEDY	194.61	
	178	MARION	SNYDER	194.61	
	459	TOMMY	COLLAZO	186.62	
	469	WESLEY	BULL	177.60	
	468	TIM	CARY	175.61	
	236	MARCIA	DEAN	175.58	
	181	ANA	BRADLEY	174.66	

INSIGHTS : The top customers contribute a large portion of total revenue. These customers are very important for the business and can be targeted for loyalty programs and special offers.

VI. Which movies are rented the most?

```
34
35  -- Most rented movies
36
37 • SELECT f.title, COUNT(*) AS rental_count
    FROM rental r
39  JOIN inventory i
40      ON r.inventory_id = i.inventory_id
41  JOIN film f
42      ON i.film_id = f.film_id
43  GROUP BY f.title
44  ORDER BY rental_count DESC
45  LIMIT 10;
46
```

RESULT :

	title	rental_count	
	BUCKET BROTHERHOOD	34	
	ROCKETEER MOTHER	33	
	RIDGEMONT SUBMARINE	32	
	GRIT CLOCKWORK	32	
	SCALAWAG DUCK	32	
	JUGGLER HARDLY	32	
	FORWARD TEMPLE	32	
	HOBBIT ALIEN	31	
	ROBBERS JOON	31	
	ZORRO ARK	31	

INSIGHTS : High-demand movies drive rental frequency, suggesting the importance of maintaining sufficient inventory for popular titles, which means they are the most popular among customers. The business should keep more inventory of these popular movies.

VII. Which movie categories generate the most revenue?

```
46
47  -- Revenue by Category
48
49 • SELECT c.name, SUM(p.amount) AS revenue
    FROM payment p
51  JOIN rental r
52      ON p.rental_id = r.rental_id
53  JOIN inventory i
54      ON r.inventory_id = i.inventory_id
55  JOIN film_category fc
    ON i.film_id = fc.film_id
57  JOIN category c
58      ON fc.category_id = c.category_id
59  GROUP BY c.name
60  ORDER BY revenue DESC;
```

RESULT :

	name	revenue	
	Sports	5314.21	
	Sci-Fi	4756.98	
	Animation	4656.30	
	Drama	4587.39	
	Comedy	4383.58	
	Action	4375.85	
	New	4351.62	
	Games	4281.33	
	Foreign	4270.67	
	Family	4226.07	
	Documentary	4217.52	
	Horror	3722.54	
	Children	3655.55	
	Classics	3639.59	
	Travel	3549.64	
	Music	3417.72	

INSIGHTS : Some movie categories generate more revenue than others. The business should focus more on high-revenue categories to increase profit.

VIII. How many rentals happen each month?

```
61  -- Rentals per Month
62
63 • SELECT DATE_FORMAT(rental_date, '%Y-%m') AS month,
64         COUNT(*) AS total_rentals
65 FROM rental
66 GROUP BY month
67 ORDER BY month;
```

RESULT :

	month	total_rentals	
	2005-05	1156	
	2005-06	2311	
	2005-07	6709	
	2005-08	5686	
	2006-02	182	

INSIGHTS : The number of rentals changes from month to month, showing that customer demand is not constant throughout the year. Some months have higher rentals, which may be due to holidays, weekends, or seasonal demand.

IX. How does revenue change over time (monthly trend)?

```
62  -- Monthly revenue trend
63
64 • SELECT DATE_FORMAT(payment_date, '%Y-%m') AS month,
65          SUM(amount) AS revenue
66 FROM payment
67 GROUP BY month
68 ORDER BY month;
```

RESULT :

	month	revenue	
	2005-05	4823.44	
	2005-06	9629.89	
	2005-07	28368.91	
	2005-08	24070.14	
	2006-02	514.18	

INSIGHTS : Revenue changes over time, and some months have higher revenue than others. This helps the business understand seasonal trends and plan marketing strategies.

X. Which actors have appeared in the most movies?

```
77  -- Top actors
78
79 • SELECT a.actor_id,
80          a.first_name,
81          a.last_name,
82          COUNT(fa.film_id) AS movie_count
83 FROM actor a
84 JOIN film_actor fa
85 ON a.actor_id = fa.actor_id
86 GROUP BY a.actor_id, a.first_name, a.last_name
87 ORDER BY movie_count DESC
88 LIMIT 10;
```

RESULT :

	actor_id	first_name	last_name	movie_count	
	107	GINA	DEGENERES	42	
	102	WALTER	TORN	41	
	198	MARY	KEITEL	40	
	181	MATTHEW	CARREY	39	
	23	SANDRA	KILMER	37	
	81	SCARLETT	DAMON	36	
	37	VAL	BOLGER	35	
	158	VIVIEN	BASINGER	35	
	106	GROUCHO	DUNST	35	
	13	UMA	WOOD	35	

INSIGHTS : These actors have appeared in the highest number of movies, which means they are frequently featured in the film inventory.

The business can use movies featuring these popular actors for promotions to attract more customers and increase rentals.

XI. Which category has the most movies?

```
90  -- Movies per category
91
92 • SELECT c.name,
93         COUNT(fc.film_id) AS number_of_movies
94 FROM film_category fc
95 JOIN category c ON fc.category_id = c.category_id
96 GROUP BY c.name
97 ORDER BY number_of_movies DESC;
```

RESULT :

	name	number_of_movies	
	Sports	74	
	Foreign	73	
	Family	69	
	Documentary	68	
	Animation	66	
	Action	64	
	New	63	
	Drama	62	
	Games	61	
	Sci-Fi	61	
	Children	60	
	Comedy	58	
	Classics	57	
	Travel	57	
	Horror	56	
	Music	51	

INSIGHTS : These categories are rented the most, which shows customer preferences. The business should focus more on these popular categories and keep more inventory in these categories.

XII. Which categories are rented the most?

```
100  -- Top 5 Categories by Number of Rentals
101
102 • SELECT c.name,
103         COUNT(*) AS total_rentals
104 FROM rental r
105 JOIN inventory i ON r.inventory_id = i.inventory_id
106 JOIN film_category fc ON i.film_id = fc.film_id
107 JOIN category c ON fc.category_id = c.category_id
108 GROUP BY c.name
109 ORDER BY total_rentals DESC
110 LIMIT 5;
111
```


RESULT :

	name	total_rentals	
	Sports	1179	
	Animation	1166	
	Action	1112	
	Sci-Fi	1101	
	Family	1096	

INSIGHTS : The categories with the most movies have a larger inventory, which means the business offers more variety in those categories.

Having more movies in a category can attract more customers because customers have more choices to rent from.

8. CONCLUSION :

In this project, we analyzed the Sakila movie rental database using SQL to understand business performance and customer behavior.

We analyzed total customers, rentals, and revenue to understand overall business size.

We identified top customers, most rented movies, and most popular categories to understand customer preferences.

We analyzed revenue by store and category to understand business performance.

We also analyzed monthly rentals and revenue trends to understand how business changes over time.

Additionally, we analyzed actors and movie categories to understand movie distribution and popularity.

This project shows how SQL can be used to analyze business data and generate useful insights for decision-making.